

Malaysia Open Virtual Karate-do Kata Competition

Goju-ryu or IKO Goju-ryu Version Only — Open Version for Kobudo (Weapon) Kata

Sensei / Coach Playbook

For every sensei and coach in this competition

1. Purpose

Malaysia Open Virtual Karate-do Kata Competition exists so that any Goju-ryu karateka, anywhere in the world, can step onto a real competitive stage without buying a plane ticket. A student in a small-town dojo and a student in a national training centre submit to the same panel, under the same rules, judged on the same criteria — distance and travel budget decide nothing.

The competition's job is to make that fair and trustworthy at scale: verified rank, verified recordings, a panel of judges who never sees who they are scoring, and a result that everyone — the participant, their sensei, and every other competitor — can check for themselves once winners are announced.

Every participant registers under a named Sensei — the instructor who trained them. Your registration is what makes that connection real in the system.

2. Identity

Malaysia Open Virtual Karate-do Kata Competition is a virtual, video-submission kata championship open to Goju-ryu and IKO Goju-ryu practitioners worldwide, plus an Open division for Kobudo (weapon) kata. It runs in three tiers — USD 10, USD 100 and USD 200 — so a first-time competitor and a seasoned Dan holder chasing a serious prize can both find their level.

It is not a video-upload contest that happens to involve karate. It is a karate competition that happens to be judged on video — the standards, the etiquette, and the seriousness of a real tournament apply throughout, from the certificate check at registration to the moment a judge scores a recording.

3. Beliefs & Values

- Honesty about your own rank comes first. Every participant confirms, in writing, that the belt rank they entered matches their uploaded certificate — a mismatch disqualifies the entry outright, no exceptions, because the whole scoring system depends on the right people being compared to the right people.

- Judging is blind and independent. A judge scores the recording in front of them, not the person — assignments, workload, and deadlines are managed so that no single judge's delay holds up a result: if a score is still missing two weeks after the deadline, the recording is reassigned; if it's still missing after that, the Chief Judge steps in before the winners are announced.
- One person, one honest attempt. Every participant gets three chances to delete and re-record a kata — enough to recover from a dropped phone or a bad take, not enough to endlessly audition for the best possible take against an opponent who only gets one submission.
- No refunds once you're in. Registration fees are not returned if a participant doesn't attend or changes their mind — the fee is what funds judges, the platform, and the prize pool for everyone who did show up.
- Respect the chain that got you here. A participant registers under their own School/Dojo and their own Sensei/Coach before registering themselves — the competition is built on the dojo relationships that trained each competitor, not on anonymous sign-ups.

4. Capabilities — What Your Registration Unlocks

As a registered Sensei / Coach, here is exactly what you can do in the Kata Arena:

- Fee: One-time tier fee (USD 10 / 100 / 200).
- Kata Arena access: Your own students only — their tier & kata events (all recordings once Winners are announced).
- Judge-by-judge scores: Round status + total only.
- Viewing: View your own students' events only (all events once Winners are announced).
- Commission: 10% of your students' fees once you have 10+ participants.
- Telegram: Your School's Telegram group.
- Sign-in allowance: Unlimited sign-ins for your competition tier once your fee is paid (your own students only).

5. Behaviors — What Is Expected Of You

- Register in the right order — School/Dojo, then Sensei/Coach, then yourself — and keep every certificate, rank, and personal detail accurate and up to date.

- Treat your recording like a real tournament performance: correct uniform, a clear view of the full kata, and the belt rank you actually hold — not the one you're hoping to earn by next year.
- Respect the clock. Registration deadlines, recording windows, judging windows, and the 25-minutes-idle auto sign-out all exist to keep 470+ competitors and their judges moving through the same tournament fairly — don't wait for the last minute.
- Keep communication inside the competition's own channels — the Telegram group for your category and the in-app Announcements page — so that changes and rulings reach everyone at once, not by word of mouth.
- Treat every judge, organizer, and fellow competitor the way you'd want to be treated on the physical tournament floor: this is a virtual dojo, but it is still a dojo.
- If you're vouching for a student's belt rank via Bulk registration, only confirm what you'd stand behind in person.
- Consider also registering as a Judge (Black Belt 1st Dan and above) and joining Participant Support — both are open to senseis and both add to what you can earn.

6. Environment — Where This All Happens

Everything happens inside one web app, reachable from any phone, tablet, or computer with a camera and an internet connection — there is no separate software to install. Recording happens through the browser itself, using the device's own camera and microphone.

The competition year runs in stages, in this order: registration and payment → kata recording and submission → the registration deadline → a judging window (roughly four weeks, with reassignment safeguards built in) → the winners announcement → certificates and testimonials.

Money moves through Stripe (card or FPX) — the competition never sees or stores your card details. Everything else — your registration record, your recording, your score, your certificate — lives inside the Kata Arena, reachable any time you sign in during your competition tier's window.

Support and announcements run through Telegram, split by category, so a message reaches exactly the people it's meant for — your own group for day-to-day matters, plus the app's own Announcements page as the permanent written record.

7. Your Step-by-Step Journey

Follow these steps in order. Each screenshot shows exactly where to click — look for the red circle.

Step 0 — Before you start, have these ready

- Your IC / Passport.
- A clear photo or scan of your latest karate rank certificate.
- Your School / Dojo's name — register it first (a separate playbook) if it isn't already in the system.
- Your bank account details for commission payout.

Step 1 — Register as Sensei / Coach

From the Home page, click Register. Choose Register my sensei if a student is registering on your behalf, or Self-register as sensei if you're doing it yourself — both lead to the same form.

The screenshot displays a registration interface with four numbered options:

- 1 School / Dojo**: Register your school or dojo so senseis and participants can select it. Registering here is not free — the one-time registration fee follows the competition tier (USD 10 / USD 100 / USD 200 per tier), whether registering yourself or on someone's behalf. Payment is taken at registration. **Register school / dojo**
- 2 My Sensei / Coach**: Students or club representatives register their sensei / coach. Registering here is not free — the one-time registration fee follows the competition tier (USD 10 / USD 100 / USD 200 per tier), whether registering yourself or on someone's behalf. Payment is taken at registration. Senseis are also warmly encouraged to join as Participant Support — help fellow karateka while staying close to the action. **Register my sensei** (highlighted with a red circle)
- 3 Sensei / Coach self-registration**: Senseis and coaches register themselves. Registering here is not free — the one-time registration fee follows the competition tier (USD 10 / USD 100 / USD 200 per tier), whether registering yourself or on someone's behalf. Payment is taken at registration. Senseis holding Black Belt 1st Dan onward and above are encouraged to also register as Judge to earn extra commission, and every sensei is warmly encouraged to join as Participant Support too.
- 4 Judges**: Register as a kata judge. USD 100 deposit per competition tier. Judge work starts after the event deadline: you have around 2 weeks after the deadline to submit your scores on the assigned participants — after the 2nd week, unscored recordings are re-assigned, and the re-assigned judge gets around 1 week. If a score is still missing, the Chief Judge takes over in the 4th week, before the winner announcement date. Black Belt 1st Dan onward and above are encouraged to register as Judge.

The Registration hub — Sensei registration options.

Select who is registering, then your name, rank, and upload your rank certificate.

Select tier ▼

The fee follows the competition tier (USD 10 / USD 100 / USD 200) and is paid once per registration.

Kata Competition Tier(s) you'll have participants in (Tier 1 required, up to 3)

Tier 1 * Tier 2 Tier 3

— None — ▼ — None — ▼ — None — ▼

Tier 1 is required — pick every tier you expect students in, up to 3. This tells the organizer which tiers to expect you in; it does not change your one-time registration fee above, and it does not decide commission — that's worked out from your own students' actual paid entries.

Who is registering? *

Select ▼

Sensei / Coach name *

Latest Rank *

e.g. Godan

IC / Passport No. *

Used later to link your sign-in account to this sensei record.

Latest rank certificate *

Who is registering, and your rank certificate.

Pick your School / Dojo from the dropdown, and which kata competition tier(s) your students will compete in.

Latest Rank *

e.g. Godan

IC / Passport No. *

Used later to link your sign-in account to this sensei record.

Latest rank certificate *

Choose file Take picture

No file selected yet.
Accepted formats: JPG, PNG, HEIC, PDF. Max 10 MB.

Sex *

Select gender ▼

School / Dojo *

Select school ▼

School not in the list? [Register it first.](#)

Email address *

name@example.com

Mobile phone *

+60...

Home address * (no comma ", " allowed in the box)

Choose your School / Dojo and competition tier(s).

Step 2 — Pay your one-time registration fee

Fill in your bank details for commission payout, then submit and complete payment via Stripe. Your registration is confirmed once payment succeeds.

any commission.

Bank name * **Account No. / IBAN ***

Bank account holder name *

Referral / Where did you hear about this competition? (optional)

Please don't name your own Dojo's PIC or Sensei here — if a friend told you about this competition, give their name instead.

Register sensei / coach

Submit your sensei / coach registration.

Step 3 — Check your email

A confirmation email arrives with your Reference ID and a link to sign in. From this point, your name appears in the Coach / Sensei dropdown for every student registering under you.

Step 4 — Sign in to the Kata Arena

Click Kata Arena Log In from anywhere on the site, then sign in with the account you registered with.

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Home Participants Winners Kata Arena Announcements **Register** **Kata Arena Log In**

Choose your registration tier

CLOSED Malaysia Open Virtual Karate-do Kata Competition 2026 — USD 10 Tier	REGISTRATION OPEN Malaysia Open Virtual Karate-do Kata Competition 2026 — USD 100 Tier	REGISTRATION OPEN Malaysia Open Virtual Karate-do Kata Competition 2026 — USD 200 Tier
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Kata Arena Log In — the sign-in point for every role, on every page.

Sign in **Create account**

Note
For your security, staying signed in with no activity for 30 minutes will automatically sign you out.
Audience / Spectator accounts are charged per sign-in — some have a limited number of sign-ins, and once used up that account can no longer sign in. A new subscription is necessary.
Participants competing in the Kata Competition get 250 sign-ins to view their own recording only, within the validity period shown at Kata Arena log-in. Need more sign-ins? Renew your subscription for 30 more sign-ins over a 3-month period, per competition tier — or register as Audience to sign in per-visit, per competition tier. Thank you for your support!

Email *

Password *

[Forgot password?](#)

☐ I am not a robot or AL *

Sign in

My Account — sign in here.

Step 5 — Watch your students' progress

My Account shows every one of your registered students' kata events and, once Winners are announced, every one of their recordings and results — restricted to your own students only.

 *This screen needs you signed in to capture — added as soon as a Kata Arena login is available.*

Step 6 — Bulk-register your students (optional)

If you have many students, use Bulk registration from the Registration hub instead of registering them one at a time — fill an on-screen table or upload a CSV, pay once for the batch, then upload. Your School and Sensei must already be registered before you can use it.

Step 7 — Ongoing: commission and communication

Once you have 10 or more registered students, you qualify for a 10% share of their registration fees. Stay in your School's Telegram group for updates from the organizer.

Quick Reference

- Registration fee is one-time, per competition tier — separate from your students' own fees.
- 10% commission once you reach 10+ registered students.
- Your School / Dojo must be registered before you register yourself.
- Bulk registration handles up to 10,000 students in one go.
- Sign in any time via Kata Arena Log In, top-right of every page.

Specially for all Goju-ryu Karateka to compete globally without leaving their beloved Country.